Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Tess Tament

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Tess Tament

Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune

Tess speaks fluent inheritance and has strong opinions about the seating plan. Tess is the only member of the Larceny dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone genuinely appreciates her opinion on culture.

• Knows **Hugh Bidder** from the collector circuit. Her crush on him is the only thing capable of flustering her.

• Has commissioned work from **Dada DiCapo** and is still explaining one of the pieces to visitors.

• Asks **Mona Lott** which international exhibitions might need a generous sponsor.

ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Tess Tament. I represent the family foundation. Contrary to what some here may think, being related to a donor is a responsibility, not a cash machine.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Tess Tament

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Longing for authority coexists with an unwanted need for Grant's approval. Her crush on Hugh makes vulnerability public.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Tess Tament

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A piano's electric cousin is hiding a note that cannot be played. Look beneath it.*

2 *Spain has a clue for you. Find Barcelona without leaving the house.*

3 *The blue cushion is comfortable. Its secret is not meant to stay buried.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Tess Tament

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Family gift for the photograph. His gift when I asked for a say. I asked Sue about the succession clause before agreeing to pose. Grant wanted me glamorous and agreeable beside it. I know how to do both. Hugh has seen me fail at agreeable. I wanted a chair in the decisions, and I wanted Grant to think I deserved it. Those wants kept getting mixed up.

IF MURDERER

> Family gift for the photograph. His gift when I asked for a say. I asked Sue about the succession clause. Grant had decided how the family seat would pass and still expected me to wait for it. Hugh has seen me fail at agreeable. I was tired of waiting while Grant praised me for being patient. He called it trust. It felt like being kept outside.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I ordered the gift glass through the shop and requested a private toast. I wanted the family argument away from the podium. During the reception I went there; his glass was waiting and he wasn't. I left the revised seating card and went to find Sue. I had rehearsed what to say to him. It sounded braver in the car.

IF MURDERER

I bought the gift glass and asked for a private toast. The family argument wasn't going onstage. I went to his place during the reception; the glass was waiting and he wasn't. I left the revised seating card. I waited longer than I meant to, then went to find Sue. He could make me feel twelve years old simply by not showing up. I'd arranged the privacy. I meant to use it to get a real answer from him.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> His glass was unwrapped when I left the seating card. I was annoyed they'd already made my present into service equipment. The manager had the toast; I went looking for Sue. The donor seat depends on the board accepting the gift. I asked for an appointment while Grant was alive. Sue, I keep remembering that I bought him a glass. Such a stupid thing to be unable to stop thinking about.

IF MURDERER

> His glass was wrapped when I left the seating card. The manager opened it for the pour and took it directly to Grant. The donor seat depends on board approval. I asked for an appointment while he was alive. Sue, I keep remembering that I bought him a glass. I wanted him to use something I had chosen for him.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Tess Tament

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not poison Grant. The draft shows I asked for the family appointment while he was alive; the board had not accepted the gift. His glass was already bare when I left my card. I do inherit. I was angry. Hugh, please don't tell me how fortunate that makes me. I have an argument waiting for someone who will never answer it, and I still want him to answer.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. His glass was already unwrapped when I left the seating card. I used poison I'd taken during the preview, then told you the shop wrapping had stayed on until the manager poured. The manager's account left an unattended glass where my account put a wrapped present. I ordered that glass and arranged the room. I knew how ordinary my visit would look. I wanted his authority without having to keep asking him for it. The agreement was still unsigned. I wanted him to hear me as an adult. Now every room in that family house will remind me of the person I made sure could never answer.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.